



2026 · PITCH METHODOLOGY DECK

Imarflex 伊瑪牌 Online Marketing Methodology

7-step workflow built for HK home-appliance DTC
in the 2026 AI-search era.

PREPARED 2026-05-30

HK home-appliance brands face three structural shifts at once.

Mid-size HK brands like Imarflex sit between mainland low-cost entrants and locked-in Japanese mindshare. 2026 changes the rules in three directions — all at the same time.

SHIFT 1 · AI SEARCH

38%

AI Overview citation rate from top-10 Google rankers

Down from 76% in mid-2025 (Wellows 2026). Good Google SEO no longer guarantees AI search visibility. 37% of product discovery now starts in AI interfaces.

SHIFT 2 · SERP CAPTURE

0

Imarflex appearances in HK 2026 IH listicles

Across ElecBoy, Beauty Review 360, HK01 — SERP locked by Panasonic, Zojirushi, Toshiba, Tiger, Philips. Brand mindshare gap is structural.

SHIFT 3 · NEW ENTRANTS

5+

Competitor IH brands going Breakout in HK Q2 2026

Cuckoo, 美的, 松井, tefal, 小米 IH all Breakout in same 30-day Trends window. Price-war is unwinnable — needs depth + DTC moat play.

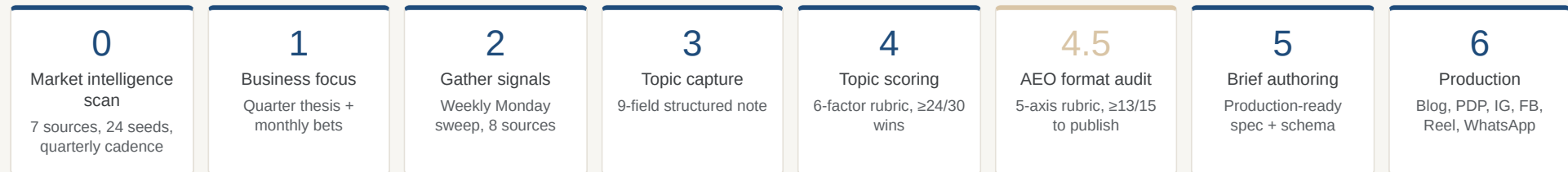
OUR RESPONSE

A 7-step workflow that **refuses to chase volume** — picks one hero per category via discipline, ships AEO-formatted content that AI engines will cite, builds DTC moat (warranty + parts) that retailers can't copy.

The 7-step workflow — each step has a skill, an agent, and a hard rule set.

Macro market scan → category bet → topic discovery → scoring → AEO format check → brief → production.

Each step refuses to ship if its hard rule fails.



5 SKILLS + 5 AGENTS

imarflex-market-scan

imarflex-business-focus

imarflex-signal-gather

imarflex-aeo

imarflex-copywriter

WHAT THIS MEANS IN PRACTICE

Each skill is a written manual the AI agents read every time. Each agent runs the step interactively with you. Hard rules (LIHKG-internal-only, no fabricated citations, no false schema) are enforced by the skill files themselves — not just team norms.

Three pillars ahead of industry. Three pillars added in this build.

Benchmarked 2026-05-27 against 16 reputable 2025-2026 industry sources (Brafton, Digital Applied, Wellows, Inspired Monks, Sequenzy, Meltwater, Marketing-Interactive, Yotpo, Shopify, McKinsey, others).

AHEAD OF INDUSTRY

- **Topic-cluster + business-focus first** — Brafton 2026: "5-8 pillar topics that map to product categories"
- **Hero-SKU concentration + 6-dim rubric** — Triple Whale: "hero products as atomic unit of business"
- **Evidence-marker discipline + Step 0 macro scan** — Digital Applied: "author identity influences page-level authority"
- **LIHKG-internal-only hard rule** — March 2026 E-E-A-T update penalises unsourced claims
- **DTC moat = warranty + parts + WhatsApp** — Volt'n'Vector: "serviceability as a feature is winning"
- **BOFU bias in content decision** — SEL: "60-80% of output goes to bottom-/mid-funnel in AI-search era"

ADDED IN THIS BUILD (MAY 2026)

- **AEO / GEO optimisation** — built as imarflex-aeo skill + auditor agent on 2026-05-27. Closes the 37% AI-discovery gap.
- **Working Google Trends access pattern** — Playwright CLI via agent-browser, 24-seed list, rate-limit operational rules. Replaces previous "best-effort, often unavailable" state.
- **Capacity-phrase reframe** — Trends compare retest proved capacity-phrase SEO has zero HK volume. Content angle pivoted to generic-funnel + family-size argument.

Designed-not-yet-built: lifecycle (email + WhatsApp), KOL programme, Reel/Short copywriter extension. Phase-2 priorities.



STEP 0 · MARKET INTELLIGENCE SCAN

Before we bet on a category, we look outside the building.

Quarterly macro scan of 7 public sources. Distills ~480 keyword signals into a 5-10 bullet "Market context" block that feeds Step 1.

SOURCES Google Trends HK · HKTVmall/豐澤/Broadway bestsellers · Competitor SKU launches (Pana/Toshiba/Tiger) · HK media editorial · LIHKG sentiment (internal-only) · Amazon JP/TW · 小紅書 (opt-in)

CADENCE Quarterly full (~2h) + monthly light refresh (~20min) + ad-hoc trigger (~30min)

OUTPUT 5-10 distilled bullets, marker + source + implication → paste into Step 1 focus doc

PITCH USE All default sources public — no client access needed

WHY THIS EXISTS

Without Step 0, focus inherits all of client's blindspots — the workflow becomes "what client wants × season", a closed loop. Step 0 is the antidote.

Trends iteration journey — why we don't accept "tool failed" as final state.

Real timeline from our Q2 build. Demonstrates how the workflow gets better when initial fetch fails.

DATE	ACTION	RESULT
2026-05-23	First Q2 scan attempt via WebFetch + 3 browser-automation tools	HTTP 429 on all 3 tools — IP-level rate limit. Marked "best-effort, often unavailable".
2026-05-27	Re-tested agent-browser CLI (Playwright) with ?date=today 1-m (30-day window instead of default 12-month)	SUCCESS — full 30-day series + Related Rising 10 queries for 電飯煲 HK
2026-05-27	Captured rising queries: panasonic 電飯煲 內膽 Breakout, 小米 IH 電飯煲 Breakout, plus cuckoo / 美的 / 松井 / tefal — all entering same window	3 Q2 decisions strengthened, 1 thesis flagged for cross-check
2026-05-30	Compare test: 電飯煲 vs 迷你 電飯煲 vs 2L 電飯煲 — to validate capacity-gap thesis	Generic 電飯煲 = avg 63, 迷你 = avg 1, 2L = avg 1. HK users don't search by capacity phrase.
2026-05-30	Thesis reframed: capacity gap is product-shelf gap (real), not search-demand gap (zero). Content angle pivot.	IRC-20IH score 16/18 → 17/18 — Demand axis upgraded with confidence

Codified into the skill

Working access pattern documented in sources-public.md. 24-seed HK list saved as seed-list-hk.md. Rate-limit operational rules in cadence-and-triggers.md.

Workflow principle exposed

When demand signal looks weak, check whether the **phrase** is wrong, not just the **concept**. Trends is a seed-expansion tool, not idea-discovery.

Pitch-stage implication

Methodology is the deliverable. At pitch we show **how we'd iterate** — not just the final answer. Client sees the discipline.



STEP 1 · BUSINESS FOCUS

One hero per category. Discipline of choice, not enthusiasm.

Two-level model: Quarter focus = thesis (categories + DTC moats). Monthly focus = bet placement (this month's promo, content, diff from quarter). Both anchored by 6-dim hero SKU rubric.

QUARTER FOCUS

Thesis (changes every 3 months)

Categories to push · hero SKUs per category · DTC moats · season arc · evergreen pillars. Output: yyyy-qx-focus.md

MONTHLY FOCUS

Bet placement (changes monthly)

This month's actual promo · SKUs being pushed · content being shipped · **diff from quarter** reconciliation table · **out of scope this month** list (mandatory). Output: yyyy-mm-focus.md

MANDATORY MONTHLY SECTIONS

Diff from quarter focus + Out of scope this month exist to catch silent-drop bugs. Example real case: Q2 focus pushed 抽濕機, monthly silently dropped it. Audit caught it. New rule enforces visible decision.

IRC-20IH hero scoring — transparent reasoning, auto-DQ rule.

Q2 2026 worked example. Every hero candidate scored 1-3 on 6 axes. Any axis = 1 → auto-DQ regardless of total.

17 / 18 IRC-20IH
 ✓ HERO

AXIS	SCORE	REASONING
M×I (margin × inv)	2 ⚠️	Placeholder pending real margin from client
Demand	3 ✓	Mother's Day peak 100 + 中容量 family-size moment
Diff	3 ✓	Product-shelf gap + 日工藝 + DTC moat
Content readiness	3 ✓	Buying-guide + carousel already drafted
DTC moat fit	3 ✓	2-yr warranty + parts-finder anchor
Brand safety	3 ✓	No reliability concerns surfaced

DQ IN ACTION — SAME QUARTER

降糖 IH (generic) = Diff axis 1 → auto-DQ. 5+ competitors selling identical 35% sugar reduction. Door reopens only when Imarflex finds specific USP.



Weekly sweep → 9-field topic capture → 6-factor rubric → priority calendar.

Q2 2026-05-30 sample: 5 IH topics surfaced from Trends + media + retailer signals. Scored. Winner picked for Step 5 brief.

TOPIC	BIZ	DEMAND	INTENT	FIT	REPURP	RANK	TOTAL	ACTION
1. 電飯煲 容量 點揀	5	5	4	5	5	4	28	✓ Next calendar
2. panasonic 電飯煲 內膽 邊度買	5	4	5	5	4	5	28	✓ Day-1 post-engagement
3. 電飯煲 母親節 / 父親節 送禮	5	5	5	4	4	4	27	✓ Timed: mid-June for 父親節
4. 小米 IH vs 主流 (defensive)	4	4	4	3	3	4	22	Backlog Q3
5. 內膽 清潔 + 替換 (retention)	4	3	3	5	5	4	24	Bundle with #2

WINNER PICK + TIE-BREAKER LOGIC

Topic 1 + Topic 2 tied at 28/30. **Topic 1 wins for next brief** — funnels generic 電飯煲 traffic (largest pool), ships pitch-stage without parts-finder backend dependency.
Topic 2 = Day-1 priority once parts-finder deploys.



STEP 4.5 · AEO FORMAT AUDIT

Get cited by ChatGPT, Perplexity, Claude — not just ranked by Google.

5-axis rubric. Pass threshold 13/15. Auto-DQ if any axis = 1 + content involves health/safety/electrical.

AXIS	WHAT IT TESTS
Passage-Q&A	Every H2 is user-phrased question; ≤ 50字 direct-answer first
Schema markup	Article + Product + FAQPage + HowTo where applicable; no false structured facts
Author identity	Named author + credentials + LinkedIn (no generic 編輯部 for YMYL)
Statement-fact	Every concrete claim has number + source URL + date
Freshness	Publish + dateModified + review cadence

WHY IT MATTERS NOW

Wellows 2026: Top-10 Google rankers held 76% of AI Overview citations in mid-2025, only 38% by early 2026. Ranking and citation are **decoupling**. AEO is the new optimisation surface.

Real audit on existing IH buying-guide blog — 8/15, rewrite needed.

Content predates AEO skill. Editorially strong (brand voice , SEO keyword targeting ) but doesn't meet 2026 AEO standards. Shows the delta from 2024-era SEO to 2026-era AEO.

8 / 15  REWRITE
+ AXIS 3 DQ-BORDERLINE

AXIS	SCORE
Passage-Q&A structure	2 
Schema markup	1 
Author identity	1 
Statement-fact pairing	2 
Freshness signal	2 

7-issue fix list

- **H2 structure** — rewrite all H2 as user-phrased questions, ≤ 50字 direct-answer first
- **Missing schema** — spec Article + Product (IRC-20IH) + FAQPage
- **Missing FAQ section** — add H2 「常見問題」 + 5 Q&A mirrored to FAQPage schema
- **Generic author** — client must provide named author + credential (Day-1 ask)
- **Unourced stats** — 「50年」, 「IH滲透率 80%」, 「鍋身 >2mm」 all need source URLs
- **Health-angle DQ trigger** — 糖尿病 mention + generic author = DQ; fix via named author OR remove mention
- **Freshness signals** — add dateModified + review cadence

WHY THIS DEMONSTRATES VALUE

Same blog was "publish-ready" by 2024 SEO standards. AEO audit surfaces the 7 changes that separate "ranks on Google" from "gets cited by AI engines". Both matter in 2026.

One topic, multiple channel outputs — all from one brief.

Brief = production spec with AEO requirements baked in. `imarflex-copywriter` agent then ships per-channel outputs from the same source.

CHANNEL	OUTPUT
Blog (zh-HK)	1,200-1,500字, AEO-formatted, Q&A H2s, FAQ section, schema spec
Instagram	8-slide carousel script + image briefs
Facebook	Hook + link post
Reel / Short	15-30s script (design-only currently, copywriter extension TBD)
WhatsApp	Consultation bot script with branching logic
PDP	Hero copy + spec table + FAQ
Email lifecycle	Trigger flow (post-engagement only)

BRAND VOICE ENFORCEMENT

Copywriter agent reads `brand/voice-tone-of-voice.md` every run. 5 adjectives (可靠 · 溫暖 · 專業 · 貼地 · 日式精緻). 3 anti-patterns. Output blocked if voice check fails.



Citation simulation — how we measure AI-search visibility lift.

12 standardized prompts × 4 LLM engines = 48-cell baseline matrix. Monthly cadence. Tracks delta over time.

Manual collection — automated runs misrepresent consumer experience.

CLUSTER 1

Category discovery

3 prompts, Imarflex unbranded.
"香港邊個牌子嘅 IH 電飯煲最值得買?"

CLUSTER 2

Brand discovery

3 prompts, Imarflex named.
"伊瑪牌 IH 電飯煲 點解 港人鍾意?"

CLUSTER 3

SKU-specific (BOFU)

3 prompts, high intent.
"IRC-20IH 好唔好用? 啱咩家庭?"

CLUSTER 4

DTC moat

3 prompts, differentiator.
"伊瑪牌 保養 點 登記?"

Recording matrix per engine

-  Imarflex in top 3 of answer
-  pos N Mentioned at position 4-10
-  No mention
-  Mentioned with hallucination — content opportunity

Expected pitch-stage baseline

- Likely 5-15 / 48 mentions (mid-size HK brand, limited training data)
- Cluster 2 (brand discovery) strongest — model has some knowledge once you name brand
- Cluster 1 (unbranded) weakest — defaults to top-of-mind brands
- SKU hallucinations expected in Cluster 3 — directly addressable via AEO content

PITCH PROMISE

Methodology demo only at pitch. No commitment to lift %. Week 1 of engagement = real baseline run. Wellows 2026 data suggests AI engines show citation pattern shift in 2-4 weeks post-publish — faster than traditional SEO (3-6 months).

Three rules we won't break, even when asked.

Rules mirrored across multiple skills + agent files + persistent memory. Multi-layer enforcement means consistent behaviour session-to-session, agent-to-agent.

1

LIHKG / Reddit / 論壇 sentiment stays internal

Never enters brief, blog, PDP, social, pitch deck, or any client-facing deliverable. Aggregate sentiment only (eg 「過去 90 日 N 條 thread 提及痛點 X」). Brand-self mentions (Imarflex) only — competitor brand sentiment never surfaces.

Why: Legal risk (quoting users without consent). E-E-A-T penalty (Google March 2026). Brand 信譽 risk if competitor sentiment used as marketing ammunition.

2

No fabricated citations or false schema facts

Every claim has URL + date + source. AEO auditor rejects content with "according to X report" but no URL. Schema declares only what PDP actually supports — no fake aggregateRating, no stale prices, no false stock status.

Why: Google penalty for false structured data. Brand 信譽. LLM hallucination amplifies false claims into AI-search answers — at scale.

3

Pitch-stage honesty — no lift commitments before measurement

At pitch stage we show **methodology**, not promises. ⚠️-heavy in scan output is normal (no client data yet). No "we'll lift your traffic X%" — we show how we'd measure, then measure honestly.

Why: Trust. Client can verify methodology rigour pre-engagement. Removes incentive to fabricate baselines.

What you get that you wouldn't from a competent generalist.

AREA	GENERIC 2026 AGENCY	OUR WORKFLOW
Topic discovery	Keyword volume → topic. Chase Search Console wins.	Business focus + macro scan → topic. Volume only sanity-checks intent.
Hero SKU	All-of-catalog promoted equally.	1 hero per category, 6-dim rubric scored, auto-DQ on any axis = 1.
Evidence discipline	Implicit. Sources cited inconsistently.	✅ / ⚠️ marker on every claim. ⚠️ items auto-map to Day-1 ask checklist.
Forum / community signal	Quoted in client-facing decks for "consumer voice".	LIHKG / Reddit internal-only. Hard rule. Mirrored across 3 skills + 2 memory files.
AEO / AI search	Bolt-on or absent. Treated as future concern.	Step 4.5 with dedicated rubric + auditor agent. Citation simulation methodology.
Pitch deliverable	Slide deck of "what we'd do".	Working artifacts — focus doc, signal sweep, brief, AEO audit, sample blog audit, simulation protocol.
Cycle visibility	Monthly report after the fact.	Quarter thesis → monthly diff → weekly signal → daily AEO audit. Every step has artifact + audit trail.
Pitch-to-engagement transition	Re-scope and redo work post-signing.	Upgrade ⚠️ to ✅ as client data arrives. Same machine, same artifacts.

Every in our pitch maps to a specific Day-1 ask.

No surprise scope creep. The  count is the onboarding checklist. Provide these on Day 1 and we upgrade to  immediately, no re-work.

CATEGORY	DAY-1 ASK	UNBLOCKS
SKU codes	Real SKU codes per priority category (placeholder IRC-20IH used pitch-side)	Hero scoring M×I axis
Margin / inventory	Per-SKU monthly margin + sustained-stock status	Hero rubric → priority ranking
Promo schedule	Forward 90-day promo + clearance roadmap	Monthly focus + content timing
Search Console	GSC export — top queries, CTR, position 8-20 quick-wins	Replaces  workflow-FAQ assumptions
Site search	Meilisearch / on-site search log — last 90 days	Captures real user wording vs assumed
WhatsApp	Sample 30 days of customer-service conversations (anonymised)	FAQ topics + consultation bot script
PostHog / analytics	Blog → PDP funnel + content engagement	Step 4 scoring "Search demand" axis
AEO authorship	Named author with credentials + LinkedIn URL per content piece	AEO Axis 3 → 3/3, neutralises DQ
Engineering	Backend platform confirmation (Shopify / Shoptline / custom)	Schema deployment route
Review system	Existing review data, if any	Review schema markup (only if real)

READY WHEN YOU ARE.

Let's begin together.

A real, working marketing operation already running for your category —
waiting to upgrade ⚠️ to ✅ on Day 1.

Imarflex Online Marketing Pitch · 2026-05-30

Methodology: `reference/methodology-summary.md`

Live Q2 focus: `online-marketing/business-focus/2026-q2-focus.md`

Skills + agents: `.claude/skills/` + `.claude/agents/`

